Assignment 1b: Strategic Framework & Job Market Gap Analysis

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1. Job Requirements Analysis

In 1a, I did not have one fixed career plan. I now want to investigate work that combines AI automation with interactive experiences. Creative technology is a useful direction to test because I enjoy connecting tools and seeing an idea become something I can use. My main project goal is to rebuild my interactive portfolio website, with previews of my own professional, course, and personal projects. I researched four U.S. listings to compare entry-level expectations with experienced and senior work. These are examples of a possible direction, rather than jobs I assume I already qualify for.

Job comparison

Listings were checked October 7, 2026 and saved in Zotero. Numbers refer to the references. Required and preferred criteria are distinguished; named tools may be examples rather than individually mandatory.

Listing / U.S. location	Level and experience	Qualifications	Tools and approaches	Responsibilities
[1] Kyndryl: Associate Creative Technologist; Frisco/Dallas, TX; R-66763	Entry-level program; prototyping experience; no numerical years specified	Required: relevant bachelor's or equivalent practical experience; AI fundamentals, interaction design, accessibility and collaboration	Low-code/prototyping tools; APIs and structured data. AR/VR, WebGL and game engines preferred	Build interactive demos; integrate systems; test, troubleshoot and document
[2] Amazon: Design Technologist II, Prime Video; Culver City/San Francisco, CA or Seattle, WA; 10507619	Mid-career comparison based on Level II title and 2+ years required	Required: online portfolio, front-end coding samples, development and complex-workflow UI experience	Team uses HTML/CSS/JS, React, Redux, Motion.js and AWS Bedrock. Python, Git and AWS experience preferred	Build functional prototypes; develop concepts with designers, researchers and engineers
[3] NEXT/NOW: Creative Technologist AI; Chicago, IL	Level and years not stated; hands-on interactive experience expected	Interactive-tool experience, generative-AI exploration, creative judgment and UX awareness; degree not specified	Examples: TouchDesigner, Unity/Unreal, WebGL, ComfyUI and AI coding tools. Physical computing is nice-to-have	Prototype interactive environments; create generative pipelines and production components
[4] Kyndryl: Senior Lead Creative Technologist; Dallas, TX; R-64636	Senior lead; 8+ years preferred	Required: relevant degree or equivalent portfolio; strategic design, risk analysis, collaboration and responsible AI	Agent-tool standards, APIs, front-end integration and evaluation; enterprise architecture knowledge preferred	Lead projects, mentor teams, advise clients and establish quality standards

Amazon is my experienced-career comparison; the employer does not explicitly label it mid-career. NEXT/NOW does not specify seniority. Kyndryl's entry role requires five days weekly in Frisco and offers no visa sponsorship [1]. Its senior role specifies hybrid work and 20% travel [4]. These conditions matter alongside technical fit.

Market reflection

These listings make my interests feel more connected, but they also show how much work I need to do. Using AI tools is relevant, especially when building interactive prototypes, yet employers also expect clear communication, testing, and work that other people can use. Amazon's portfolio and coding-sample requirements make rebuilding my website more useful than simply collecting another tool [2]. It should show how I approached a problem and what I understand about the result. Kyndryl's senior role also shows that growth involves guiding teams and setting standards, not only making more complicated projects [4]. For now, I want to focus on finishing smaller things and explaining them clearly. These four listings are a limited sample, so they do not settle my whole career. They give me a better question to work on: can I turn my experiments into reliable, understandable projects that demonstrate both technical progress and thoughtful interaction?

2. Skills Gap Analysis

Required skills versus current proficiency

Required skill / source	My current proficiency	Gap to bridge
Interactive prototyping and UI [1-3]	Developing: interested in interactive experiences and rebuilding my portfolio	Finish a usable website; check responsive behavior, accessibility and navigation
Programming and integration [1, 2]	Beginner independently: can follow basic codebase structure; configured OpenClaw and models	Explain code and API data flow; make small changes and troubleshoot failures
AI workflow experimentation [1, 3]	Hands-on: use n8n; wrote memory instructions and organized information in Obsidian	Explain a repeatable workflow and each tool's contribution
Testing and evaluation [1, 4]	Informal: observed improved memory retention and some token reduction	Record fixed test cases and results instead of relying only on impressions
User control and responsible AI [4]	Developing awareness: use a separate experimental machine and limit accessible files	Document and test permission boundaries and recovery behavior
Portfolio and documentation [1, 2, 4]	Developing: many previous GitHub experiments were deleted	Preserve projects, previews, setup notes and clear contribution records
Collaboration and communication [1-4]	Developing: support the Intelligence Society's engineer-president with technical experiments	Explain decisions, seek feedback and document my contribution

Skills-gap reflection

My biggest gap is understanding the code well enough to judge and maintain what I build. I can configure tools and follow the basic structure of a project, but I still need help with many coding problems. Rebuilding my portfolio gives me a reason to practice through specific tasks, such as making project previews work and understanding how the pages respond to user actions.

My OpenClaw memory work is another starting point. I noticed high token usage and poor retention between sessions. I wrote instructions, organized information in Obsidian, and used an existing repository to restructure the memories. Recall became better and token usage went down somewhat, but I did not measure the change. That experience shows me why testing matters. I want to use repeatable questions and record results instead of saying a system feels better.

I also need better documentation. Keeping explanations, failures, and improvements alongside each project would help me learn and give people something concrete to review. My goal is to become more independent while still learning from AI and from people with stronger technical experience.

3. Personal Alignment & Resource Awareness

Values reflection

This direction fits what I enjoy: experimenting, connecting ideas, and making something useful or interactive. I want my portfolio to be a place where my course, personal, and professional work can live together, with previews that help people understand each project. I also value learning with people who share my interests and ethics. The Intelligence Society has given me that kind of community, and I want to keep contributing while learning from its more experienced members. Schoolwork and building my knowledge come first. I do not want a plan that depends on constantly buying tools or taking on more than I can finish. Security remains important because an assistant with access to personal information should have clear limits and understandable behavior.

Resource constraints

I can spend three to four hours a week on this development, so I need one main project and a manageable supporting workflow. My total AI budget is $20-$60 per month, including existing subscriptions. I want to stay near the lower end and use the tools I already have before paying for anything new. My international-student situation also places limits on my plans. I should not assume that a U.S. listing means I can take that job, especially where the employer states a sponsorship restriction [1]. For now, learning and documenting projects are clearer goals than starting a business without a defined product or customer.

Resource	Available / constraint	Planned response
Time	3-4 hours weekly; schoolwork first	Aim for 3.5 hours: learning 45 minutes, building 60, testing 60, documentation 45
Money	$20-$60 monthly total AI spending, existing subscriptions included	Track subscriptions and usage together; prefer existing tools and free learning resources
Tools/software	Experimental machine, OpenClaw, Obsidian, n8n, model access and GitHub experience	Begin with current resources; choose only the website tools needed for the project
Manpower/network	Intelligence Society peers and its engineer-president	Request limited feedback; keep responsibility for my own work

4. Actionable Goals & Timeline

I expect to graduate in May 2028. My short-term goals build a foundation while I am in school. My long-term objectives focus on positioning my work after graduation.

Short-term goals: 6 months to 1 year

1. **By April 7, 2027:** document one Donna workflow, make one small script or integration change, and record five test cases. I want to explain its inputs, outputs, and failure handling in my own words.

2. **By July 7, 2027:** test the memory system with ten dummy-information questions across three sessions, recording recall and token usage where available. I will also test three permission or failure scenarios and report current performance if a fair earlier baseline is unavailable.

3. **By October 7, 2027:** rebuild my interactive portfolio with professional, course, and personal categories, at least three project previews, and two detailed case studies. I will gather feedback from two peers and document two improvements.

Long-term objectives: 1 to 3 years

1. **By July 7, 2028:** complete one collaborative project and add a case study explaining my technical contribution, test results, and handoff instructions.

2. **By October 7, 2028:** maintain three finished case studies on the portfolio, each with a preview or recorded demo, technical explanation, and limitations. I want to explain one project without relying on AI for the explanation.

3. **By October 7, 2029:** compare five fresh U.S. listings, choose a primary specialization, and prepare a targeted resume and portfolio presentation. I will review skill gaps and applicable work restrictions before deciding my next career step.

Timeline

Period / target date	Steps	Evidence of completion
October-December 2026	Inventory tools and costs; select projects; plan portfolio categories and previews	Cost inventory, project list and site outline
January-April 7, 2027	Practice coding through one workflow change; begin website structure	Documented change and five test cases
April-July 7, 2027	Run memory and permission tests; develop project previews	Three-session results and working previews
July-October 7, 2027	Finish website, write two case studies and collect feedback	Three previews, two case studies and two improvements
October 2027-May 2028	Develop a collaborative contribution while completing my degree	Contribution records; expected graduation in May 2028
May-July 7, 2028	Finish the collaborative project and document my contribution after graduation	Case study and handoff instructions
July-October 7, 2028	Refine and maintain three finished case studies	Updated portfolio and project explanations
October 2028-October 7, 2029	Refresh research and choose a specialization	Five-listing comparison, resume and portfolio presentation

References

All listings were accessed October 7, 2026 and saved in my Zotero collection.

1. Kyndryl. (2026, October 2). Early Career Consult Program - Associate Creative Technologist (R-66763). Kyndryl Careers.
2. Amazon.com Services LLC. (n.d.). Design Technologist II, Prime Video (10507619). Amazon Jobs.
3. NEXT/NOW. (n.d.). Creative Technologist AI. NEXT/NOW Careers.
4. Kyndryl. (2026, October 5). Senior Lead Creative Technologist (R-64636). Kyndryl Careers.